government had declared itself an Islamic Republic, there was no reason for India to show coolness towards the regime or to write off Bangladesh in a mood of despondency. There were also strong views within the MEA that the Indian officials posted at the Dhaka mission who had returned after the coup should go back to Dhaka as a long stay in New Delhi could give the impression that India was still displeased with the new government. Besides, it was clear that India needed first-hand information as well as political analysis of the new forces and new personalities that had come up in Bangladesh after the coup. Narayanan said:

My feeling is that immediately the new regime in Bangladesh would try to reassure India that no changes in relationship with India have taken place as a result of change in the government. Even if there will be greater friendliness towards Pakistan, Bangladesh is likely to remain an entity independent of Pakistan and also, of India. This would be a complicated situation, which would try our nerves very much in the future. However, on the diplomatic plane, the wisest course for us now would be to treat Bangladesh on a normal basis, recognising the new government and continuing our diplomatic representation.

The external spy agency still had a small network in Bangladesh, that supplied sketchy information. The sub-sources or paid agents had either dried up after the coup or gone underground fearing persecution if exposed. Nevertheless, the Indian spy agency continued to hunt for key figures in Bangladesh who might change the course of the country's political future.